

Curriculum Vitae
Anders T. Van Sandt

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I. EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Agricultural and Natural Resource Economics, Colorado State University, 2018
Dissertation: "Regional Dimensions of Agritourism: Exploring Spatial and Visitor Heterogeneity"
Advisor: Dr. Dawn Thilmany
- B.A. (Cum Laude) Economics, Linfield University, 2012

II. RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Regional economics and rural economic development
Secondary: Health, regional food systems, entrepreneurship, and agricultural marketing

III. PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Colorado State University

Aug. 2025-Current Assistant Professor of Rural Economic Development, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, Fort Collins, CO.

University of Wyoming

Aug. 2020-Aug. 2025 Assistant Professor of Regional Economics, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, Laramie, WY.

University of Kentucky

Aug. 2019-Aug. 2020 Visiting Scholar, Department of Agricultural Economics, Federal Statistical Research Data Center, Lexington, KY.

Texas A&M University

Aug. 2018-Aug. 2020 Postdoctoral Extension Associate, Community Economics and Business Development, College Station, TX.

Colorado State University

Spring 2018	Instructor, <i>Agricultural and Resource Economics</i> , Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, AREC 202-Principles of Microeconomics
Spring 2017	Instructor, <i>Agricultural and Resource Economics</i> , Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, AREC 202-Principles of Microeconomics
Summer 2015	Summer Intern, Economic Research Service – USDA
Fall 2013-2018	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, Colorado State University

IV. PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Journal Articles

18. **Van Sandt, A.**, Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., Loveridge, S., and Niehm, L. (2025). “Revealing U.S. Retail Industries’ Functional Hierarchy Through Demand Thresholds” Accepted at *Journal of Economic Structures*, September 2025.
17. Keller, M. L., Hansen, K., Cooper, K. E., Donaldson, E., Kim, M., Landreville, K. D., ... & **Van Sandt, A.** (2025). Unwinding the Spiral of Silence in Rural America: Looking Backward with Stories to Plan Forward. *Frontiers in Climate*, 7, 1398452.
16. **Van Sandt, A.**, Thilmany, D., & Gwin, L. (2024). “A comment on USDA Food Business Centers: Collaborations to nurture innovation in the food system.” *Food Policy*, 128(10272). doi: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodpol.2024.102727>
15. **Van Sandt, A.**, Pokharel, R., Carpenter, C. W., and Loveridge, S. (2024). “Improving Models of Wood Products Plant Locations with Restricted Access Data.” *Forest Policy and Economics*, 167, 103303.
14. **Van Sandt, A.**, Carpenter, C. W., Tolbert, C. (2023). “Decomposing local bank impacts with demand thresholds.” *The Annals of Regional Science*, 1-20. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00168-022-01148-4>
13. Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.**, and Loveridge, S. (2022). “Food and Agricultural Industry Locational Determinants Research: Aggregation Bias and Size Measurement in the Agricultural Support Industry.” *Agricultural and Resource Economics Review*, 51(3), 558-578. <https://doi.org/10.1017/age.2022.21>

12. Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.**, Dudensing, R., Loveridge, S., and Niehm, L. (2022). "The Economic Opportunity Mapping (EOM) Tool." *Journal of Extension*, 60, no. 4 (2022): 3.
11. **Van Sandt, A.**, Carpenter, C. W. (2022). "So Close, Yet so Far: The Benefits and Limits of Rural-urban Industry Linkages." *Sustainability* 14(5), 2875. doi: 10.3390/su14052875
10. Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., and **Van Sandt, A.** (2022). "Estimating Determinants of Establishment Locations of Transportation and Warehousing Industries Using U.S. Administrative Data." *REGION*, 9(1), doi: <https://doi.org/10.18335/region.v9i1.366>
9. Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.**, & Loveridge, S. (2021). Empirical Methods in Business Location Research. *Regional Studies, Regional Science*, 8(1), 344-361, doi: 10.1080/21681376.2021.1976261
8. Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.**, & Loveridge, S. (2021). Measurement error in US regional economic data. *Journal of Regional Science*, 62(1) 57-80. doi: 10.1111/jors.12551
7. Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.**, Dudensing, R., & Loveridge, S. (2021). Profit pools and determinants of potential county-level manufacturing growth. *International Regional Science Review*, 45(2), 188-224. doi: 01600176211028761
6. **Van Sandt, A.**, Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., & Loveridge, S. (2021). Estimating determinants of healthcare establishment locations with restricted federal administrative data. *Health Economics*, 30(6), 1328-1346.
5. **Van Sandt, A.** & Thilmany, D. (2020). "Navigating the Corn Maze: Customizing travel cost models to value market segments in heterogeneous industries. *Tourism Economics*, 28(4), 899-919. doi: 1354816620976968
4. **Van Sandt, A.**, Low, S., Jablonski, B. B., & Weiler, S. (2019). "Place-Based Factors and the Performance of Farm-Level Entrepreneurship: A Spatial Interaction Model of Agritourism in the US." *Review of Regional Studies*, 49(3), 428-453.
3. **Van Sandt, A.**, Low, S. A., & Thilmany, D. (2018). "Exploring Regional Patterns of Agritourism in the U.S.: What's Driving Clusters of Enterprises?" *Agricultural and Resource Economics Review*, 47(3), 592-609. doi: 10.1017/age.2017.36
2. **Van Sandt, A.**, & McFadden, D. T. (2016). "Diversification through Agritourism in a Changing US Farmscape." *Western Economics Forum*, 15(1), 52.
1. Martin, M. J., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Thilmany D. (2016). "Colorado Residents Trusted Sources of Agricultural, Biotechnology and Food Information." *AgBioForum*.

Book Chapters & Reviews

Van Sandt, A. (2023). "Cultural Heritage, Creativity and Economic Development." By Silvia Cerisola. 2019. pp. 208. ISBN: 978 1 78897 528 5. *Growth & Change*, 54(1), 346-347.

Van Sandt, A., D. Thilmany and R. Hill (2019). "Targeting Agritourism to Leverage the Unique Natural Resources Base and Heritage of the Rural West." Chapter in *Agritourism, Wine Tourism, and Craft Beer Tourism: Local Responses to Peripherality Through Tourism Niches*. Co-Editors: Maria Giulia Pezzi, Alessandra Faggian, and Neil Reid.

Thilmany, D. R. Hill, M. Haefele, **A. Van Sandt**, C. Thomas, M. Sullins and S. Low (2019). "An Overview of Agricultural and Rural Outdoor Recreation Tourism in the United States: A Framework for Understanding Economic and Employment Dynamics." Chapter in *Rural Policies and Employment*. Co-Editors: Sophia Davidova, Ken Thomson, and Ashok Mishra.

Extension Publications, Reports, and Materials

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Food Assistance and Resilience in Colorado: The Changing Role of SNAP. REDI Report. Regional Economic Development Institute, Colorado State University. November 12, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming's Local Food System. University of Wyoming Extension. Bulletin publication number B-1402. February 10, 2025.

Alexander, A., Aadland, D., **Van Sandt, A.** (2024). Wyoming Economic Outlook - 2025. Center for Business and Economic Analysis, University of Wyoming. Laramie, WY. Prepared for Wyoming Business Council. Van Sandt was a contributor to the forecast and produced the Agriculture section of the final report.

Van Sandt, A., Aadland, D. (2024). Evaluating the Return on Investment (ROI) for the Wyoming Innovation Partnership (WIP) Initiative. Laramie, WY: Center for Business and Economic Analysis (CBEA). Prepared for Wyoming Governor's Office.

Hansen, K., **Van Sandt, A.** (2023). Wyoming Perceptions of Extreme Weather Events. *CowCountry*, Wyoming Stock Growers Association. 2023.

Hansen, K., **Van Sandt, A., Hewlett, J.** (2023). Calculation of Appropriate Risk Premiums for SCPP Enrollment. Prepared for Wyoming State Engineers Office. April 2023.

Aadland, D., **Van Sandt, A., and Nevels, S.** (2023). Evaluating the Economic Impact of Providing Municipal Water to Laramie County Housing Developments. Laramie, WY:

Center for Business and Economic Analysis (CBEA). Prepared for Cheyenne Mayor's Office.

Van Sandt, A. and Daniels, J. (2022), "State Health Improvement Forum Analysis of Deliberative Dialogue Forums." University of Wyoming Extension Service. Prepared for the State of Wyoming, Department of Health. October, 2022.

Bastian, C., **Van Sandt, A.**, and Coupal, R., (2022). "2021 Wyoming Comprehensive Off-Road Vehicle Recreation Report." University of Wyoming, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics. Prepared for the State of Wyoming, Department of State Parks and Cultural Resources. October 2022.

Meier, C., Ward, L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Schneider, S., Gayle, R. (2022). "Western Region Health & Wellness Programming Efforts: Qualitative Results from a Three-Part Listening Session." Paper 2295. Utah State University Extension.
https://digitalcommons.usu.edu/extension_curall/2295/

Van Sandt, A. (2022). "Big Horn County Socioeconomic Profile." University of Wyoming Extension Service. Prepared for Big Horn County Commissioner's Office. July 31, 2022.

Williams, D., **Van Sandt, A.** (2022). "Assessing Total Personal Income and its Components for the United States, Rocky Mountain Region, Wyoming, and its Counties (2001-2018)." University of Wyoming Extension Bulletin B-1381, August 2022.

Bastian, C., **Van Sandt, A.**, and Coupal, R., (2022). "2020-2021 Wyoming Comprehensive Snowmobile Recreation Report." University of Wyoming, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics. Prepared for the State of Wyoming, Department of State Parks and Cultural Resources.

Khalaf, C., **Van Sandt, A.**, & Boyles, B. (2022). "Evaluating the Economic Impact of the Nonprofit Sector in Wyoming." Laramie, WY: Center for Business and Economic Analysis (CBEA). Prepared for the Align Team.

Van Sandt, A., Carpenter, C. W. (2022). "Rural-Urban Industry Linkages." *Scholarly Community Encyclopedia*. March 2nd, 2022.

Van Sandt, A., Daniels, J., Robinson, T., and Turner, F. (2022). "Final Report – The UCHAT Project." University of Wyoming Grand Challenges Committee. February, 2022.

Van Sandt, A., and Carpenter, C. W. (2021). "A Note on the Locational Determinants of the Agricultural Supply Chain." United States Census Bureau, Center for Economic Studies, Paper No. CES-21-16. <https://www.census.gov/library/working-papers/2021/adrm/CES-WP-21-16.html>

- Van Sandt, A.** (2020). "Navigating and Interpreting Economic Opportunity Maps: A User's Guide." December 30th.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2020). "Effects of COVID-19 on Wyoming Employment." University of Wyoming Extension Bulletin, December 10th.
- Whitt, C., Low, S. A., **Van Sandt, A.** (2019). "Agritourism Allows Farms to Diversify and Has Potential Benefits for Rural Communities." *Amber Waves*, November 4th.
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Risk Management." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Collaboration." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Marketing Basics." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Location." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Hospitality." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Thilmany, D., Hardesty, S., Sullins, M., Hill, R. L., **Van Sandt, A.**, Gaede, D., Leff, P., Low, S. A. (2019). "Agritourism Best Practices: Your Visitors." Available at: <https://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/>
- Van Sandt, A.** and Thilmany, D. (2018). "Relationships Between Agritourism Operations and Place-Based Factors." *Regional Economic Development Institute*, February, 2018.
- Van Sandt, A.** & D. Thilmany, (2016). "How to Cater Your Agritourism Enterprise to Travelers: Exploring Differences in Traveler Demand in the Western U.S." *Economic Development Report*, 16 (2).
- Van Sandt, A.** and D. Thilmany (2016). Agritourists in the West. CSU Extension QuickFacts. <http://agritourism.localfoodeconomics.com/quick-facts/>

Van Sandt, A. & Thilmany, D. (2016). “Mapping the Western U.S. Agritourism Industry: How do Travel Patterns Vary by Location?” *Economic Development Report*, 16 (1).

Other Media Appearances & Interviews

Braithwaite, M. (2025). “Gas Price Drop Could Increase Holiday Spending, Experts Say”. Expert interview with The Denver Gazette. December 12, 2025

Braithwaite, M. (2025). “Can You Afford to Live in Denver?”. Expert interview with The Denver Gazette. December 4, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming’s Local Food System. Interview with Global Food Collaborative. May 30th, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming’s Local Food System. Interview with Wyoming Public Radio. April 4th, 2025.

V. WORKING PAPERS

Gruber, A., **Van Sandt, A.**, Carpenter, C.W., Loveridge, S. (2025). Nurse Practitioner Training and Local Medical Provider Supply. Revise & Resubmit at *Journal of Health Economics*, November 2025.

Van Sandt, A., Line, K., Gruber, A., Carpenter, C.W., Meier, C., Loveridge, S. (2025). Perceptions of Rural Emergency Hospital Conversions. Revise & Resubmit at *Journal of Rural Health*, November 2025.

Niehm, L., McKinney, S., Carpenter, C.W., **Van Sandt, A.**, Dudensing, R., and Loveridge, S. (2025). “Addressing Operational Challenges and Opportunities for Rural Business Development: The Role of Community Capitals.” Submitted to *Journal of Community Development*, November 2025.

Van Sandt, A., Hansen, K., Cooper, K., Keller, M., Landreville, K., Paige, G., and Shinker, J. (2024). “A Choice Experiment of Wyoming Residents’ Preferences Toward Water Resilience Improvement Programs.” Working paper.

Van Sandt, A., Bonanno, A. (2024). “Hospital Access and COVID-19 Mortality: An Empirical Investigation of Rural America.”

VI. SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

- Van Sandt, A.,** Line, K., Gruber, A., Meier, C., Carpenter, C. W., Loveridge, S. (2025). "Rural Emergency Hospitals: Emerging Patterns of Adaptation and Community Perception." Presented at North American Regional Science Council meetings. Denver, CO. November 2025.
- Van Sandt, A.,** Regmi, S. (2025). "Exploring Potential Rural Economic Development Opportunities." Presented at joint *Western and American Agricultural Economics Association* meetings. Denver, CO. July 2025.
- Van Sandt, A.,** Hill, R. (2025). "Exploring the Spatial and Regional Dimensions of Food Systems." Presented at joint *Western and American Agricultural Economics Association* meetings. Denver, CO. July 2025.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2024). "The Influence of Hospital Access on Rural U.S. Mortality." Presented at *Mississippi State University, Department of Agricultural Economics Seminar Series*. Starkville, MS. October 2024.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2023). "A Choice Experiment of Wyoming Residents' Preferences Toward Water Resilience Improvement Programs." Presented at *American Agricultural Economics Association*. Washington, D.C., July 2023.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2023). "The Influence of Hospital Access on Rural U.S. Mortality." Presented at *University of Wyoming Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics Seminar Series*. Laramie, Wyoming, April 2023.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2022). "Building Community Health Access." Presented at *University of Wyoming Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics Seminar Series*. Hybrid, October 2022.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2021). "So Close, Yet So Far: The Benefits and Limits of Rural-Urban Industry Linkages" Presented at *North American Regional Science Council*. Denver, Colorado, November 2021.
- Van Sandt, A.** (2021). "Community Opportunity Matching" Presented at the *Economic Research Service, USDA* seminar series. Virtual, October 2021.
- Van Sandt, A.,** Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., and Loveridge, S. (2019). "Locational Determinants of Health Care Establishments: An Application of Federal Administrative Data." Presented at *North American Regional Science Council*. Pittsburgh, PA, November 2019.
- Van Sandt, A.,** Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., Loveridge, S., and Niehm, L. (2019). "Supply Thresholds: A New Conception for Business Locational Choice Research." Presented at *North American Regional Science Council*. Pittsburgh, PA, November 2019.

Van Sandt, A., Carpenter, C. W., Dudensing, R., Loveridge, S., and Niehm, L. (2019). “Estimating Retail Establishment and Employment Demand Thresholds using Microdata.” Presented at *Annual Conference of the Federal Statistical Research Data Centers*. Madison, WI, September 2019.

Carpenter, C. W., **Van Sandt, A.,** Loveridge, S., and Dudensing, R. (2019). “Modeling Location Decisions of Food and Agricultural Industry Establishments with Microdata.” Presented at *American Agricultural Economics Association*. Atlanta, GA, July 2019.

Van Sandt, A., Costanigro, M., and Thilmany, D. (2017). “The Impact of Consumer Heterogeneity and Surrounding Amenities in Determining Traveler Behavior: A Choice Experiment on Agritourism.” Presented at *American Agricultural Economics Association*. Chicago, IL, July 2017.

Van Sandt, A. & Thilmany, D. (2017). “Navigating the Corn Maze: Valuing Market Segments in Heterogeneous Industries.” Presented at *Western Ag Economics Association*. Lake Tahoe, NV, July 2017.

Van Sandt, A. & Thilmany, D. (2017). “Navigating the Corn Maze: Valuing Market Segments in Heterogeneous Industries.” Presented at *Cornell University*, Ithaca, NY, April 2017.

Van Sandt, A., Low, S. A., & Thilmany, D. (2016). “Place Based Factors and the Success of Farm Level Agritourism: A Gravity Model of Agritourism in the U.S.” Presented at *North American Regional Science Council*. Minneapolis, MN, November 2016.

Van Sandt, A. & Thilmany, D. (2016). “Exploring the Economics of Agritourism: Customizing Travel Cost Methods to Evaluate Differences Across the Western U.S.” Presented at *American Agricultural Economics Association*. Boston, MA, August 2016.

Van Sandt, A., Low, S. A., & Thilmany, D. (2015). “A Spatial Analysis of Agritourism in the U.S.: What’s Driving Clusters of Enterprises?” Presented at *North American Regional Science Council*. Portland, OR, November 2015.

VII. SELECTED EXTENSION PRESENTATIONS

Van Sandt, A., Carpenter, C. W. (2025). Mapping Economic Opportunity in Rural America. Council on Food, Agricultural, and Resource Economics (C-FARE) Webinar: Timely Topics in Regional Economic Development. September 26th, 2025. <https://www.cfare.org/items/regionaleconomicdevelopment>

Keller, M., **Van Sandt, A.** (2025). Unwinding the Spiral of Silence in Rural America: Looking Backward with Stories to Plan Forward. Water in the West Colloquium. University of Wyoming. September 26th, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming's Local Food System. Wyoming Food Coalition's Speaker Series. Online. June 26th, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming's Local Food System. Presented to Powder River Basin Resource Council. Sheridan, WY. May 8th, 2025.

Faulkner, J., **Van Sandt, A.**, Hemken, M. (2024). "Wyoming Business Builder Grant Announcement and Q&A Session: USDA Regional Food Business Center." Wyoming Food Coalition Conference. Casper, WY, November 2024.

Van Sandt, A. (2024). "Local and Regional Foods Division Webinar Series." Featured panelist for USDA webinar. Online, October 2024.

Van Sandt, A., Thilmany, D. (2024). "Mapping Insights: Food Systems Data Explorer." Northwest and Rocky Mountain Regional Food Business Center Annual Retreat. Portland, OR, September 2024.

Van Sandt, A., Aadland, D. (2024). "Evaluating the Return on Investment (ROI) for the Wyoming Innovation Partnership (WIP) Initiative." Presented to the Wyoming Joint Education Committee (State House and Senate members). Casper, WY, August 2024.

Van Sandt, A., Aadland, D. (2024). "Evaluating the Return on Investment (ROI) for the Wyoming Innovation Partnership (WIP) Initiative." Presented to the Governor of Wyoming. Online August 2024.

Tabler, J., **Van Sandt, A.** (2023). "Leveraging Data - Wyoming Integrated Statistics Environment." Presented at *Wyoming Conference on Aging: Rural Age-Friendly Innovation*. Laramie, Wyoming, September 2023.

Van Sandt, A. (2022). "The UCHAT Project: Unlocking Community Health Access Together." Presented at *Wyoming Healthy Aging Coalition*. Virtual, March 2022.

Van Sandt, A. (2022). "The UCHAT Project: Unlocking Community Health Access Together." Presented at *University of Wyoming Grand Challenges Week*. Virtual, February 2022.

Van Sandt, A., Daniels, J. (2021). "Economic Opportunity Maps: Starting Conversations for the Goals of Tomorrow." Series presented at the *Wyoming Association of Municipalities, Wyoming Association of County Officers, and Wyoming Economic Development Association*. WY, Summer-Fall 2021.

VIII. PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT (EXTENSION) ACTIVITIES

Responding To America's Rural Health Challenge

This integrated project is in its first stages, but the groundwork is being laid to inform and support future research-driven Extension programs. We have begun holding listening sessions with 1) Extension professionals, 2) public health professionals, and 3) workforce development professionals, to better understand the challenges and needs of rural health systems. These conversations and connections will inform our research with restricted-access data and lead to targeted and specialized programs, tools, and information for local, state, and national stakeholders.

2024: Listening Sessions: 64 participants thus far. Three series for Extension, Workforce Development, and Public Health professionals.
Hired Postdoctoral Research Associate (starting January, 2025)

NW and Rocky Mountain Regional Food Business Center – Wyoming Co-lead

While RFBC activities in Wyoming are just beginning, we have recently been working with our state steering committee on three different fronts. First, we are developing a survey for meat processors regarding offal disposal and rendering. Second, we have awarded three food businesses with travel stipends to attend the 2024 Fancy Food Show in Las Vegas, NV, to learn about product development and marketing. Third, we are working with tribal, Latinx, and persistent poverty communities to identify challenges and barriers to participating and succeeding in Wyoming's food system. We also have plans to develop a competitive grant for underserved food businesses in Wyoming. All center activities can be categorized into coordination, technical assistance, and capacity building.

Website: <https://nwrockymountainregionalfoodbusiness.com/wyoming/>

2024 – Fancy Food Show, Las Vegas, NV. The businesses reported they increased their marketing knowledge and found new possibilities to take their brand national and international.

- Sponsored and organized Wyoming Food Coalition conference, including a Buyer/Grower event, in Casper, WY
- Developed Wyoming's Business Builder grant program (Phase I: \$250k)
- Hired Grant Coordinator as UW Local Foods System Extension Specialist
- Sent WY food business (pilot) to Getting Your Recipe Ready for Market (GYRM) program at Portland Community College, OR
- Sent three WY food businesses to Fancy Food Show in Las Vegas, NV
- Shared Kitchen 101 – workshop on starting, operating, and expanding shared kitchens in Wyoming. At Central WY College, taught by the Food Corridor, LLC. 22 participants.

The Wyoming Integrated Statistics Environment (WISE)

Once completed, WISE will improve local strategic planning, increase decision makers' capacity, and assist with business births or branch location. WISE is an online interactive map where stakeholders can access timely and nuanced data on their community. The tool includes economic, demographic, health, tourism, financial, land, and many other

types of data. WISE automatically updates new data once available, is financially sustainable, and establishes partnerships across state agencies and organizations.

The Unlocking Community Health Access Together (UCHAT) Project

This project seeks to improve health outcomes for Wyoming residents through exploring Wyomingites' barriers to engagement in public health decisions and their preferred health improvement strategies. This project supports the Wyoming Department of Health's (WDH) State Health Improvement Plan (SHIP).

Student led group interviews: Women Infants and Children Program, Laramie Downtown Clinic, and County Public Health Officials. August-November 2021.

Virtual Roundtables: Online deliberations using Common Ground for Action to select WDH's proposed SHIP strategies. There were six two-hour sessions for each topic: Behavioral Health, Unintentional Injury, and Healthcare Access. Dec. 6-15, 2021

Community-Opportunity Matching Program

The primary goal of this program is to support rural economic growth by identifying opportunities and barriers to entrepreneurs and businesses within local, specific industries. As part of the project, Dr. Van Sandt developed several events and tools:

Series of virtual focus groups: US Manufacturing, *North Central Regional Center for Rural Development*, October 2018.

Series of virtual focus groups: US Retail, *North Central Regional Center for Rural Development*, September 2018.

National Webinar: "Opportunity Matching for Small Businesses and Communities", *North Central Regional Center for Rural Development*, March 2019.

Economic Opportunity Maps: Retail, Manufacturing, and Health Services, *Texas A&M University and Michigan State University*, August 2020. Available at:
Texas A&M: <https://communities.tamu.edu/economic-opportunity-maps/>
Michigan State: https://www.canr.msu.edu/economic_development/economic-opportunity-maps/
University of Wyoming: <https://www.uwyo.edu/uwe/economic-opportunity-maps/>

IX. GRANTS, CONTRACTS, AND DATA PROPOSALS (over \$2.8M received)

Farm and Food Rural Analytics for Market Empowerment: Food and Agriculture Mapper and Explorer (FAME) Updates and Analysis. **\$126,635 funded cooperative agreement** from USDA-AMS. Co-PI with Libby Christensen, Dawn Thilmany, Matt McFadden, and Jayna Mallon. October 2025.

Title V Maternal and Child Health Needs Assessment Community and Family Engagement. \$149,966 unfunded proposal to the Wyoming Department of Health. Co-PI with Grace Shearer (PI) and Juliet Daniels. January 2024.

NW & Rocky Mountain Regional Food Business Center. **\$1,865,240 funded subaward** (\$1,365,240 subcontract plus \$500,000 to distribute as grants through state specific RFA) from Colorado State University. \$30M in total funding from *USDA Regional Food Business Centers*. 2023-2028. State Lead (Co-lead Melissa Hemken at Central Wyoming College).

Responding To America's Rural Health Challenge: Data-Driven Support for a Critical Era. **\$650,000 funded proposal** from *USDA-National Institute of Food and Agriculture*. 2023-2027. Principal Investigator (with Craig W. Carpenter, Cris Meier, and Scott Loveridge).

Exploring the Impact of Comprehensive Health Care Access on Health Outcomes Across the U.S. **Data proposal, approved** January 2022. *Federal Statistical Research Data Center, U.S. Census Bureau*. 2023-2028. Principal Investigator (with Craig W. Carpenter and Scott Loveridge).

The Unlocking Community Health Access Together (UCHAT) Project. **\$20,000 funded proposal** from *University of Wyoming Grand Challenges Initiative, Research Planning Council*. 2021. Principal Investigator (with Juliet Daniels, Timothy Robins, Mariah Ehmke, and the Wyoming Department of Health).

At Risk Community Mapping: Evaluating Access to Healthcare in Rural America. **\$165,000 funded proposal** from *USDA-National Institute of Food and Agriculture*. Accepted March 2020. Principal Investigator (with Craig W. Carpenter and Alison Davis).

The grant funds were returned to NIFA after receipt because PI Van Sandt became ineligible for the Postdoctoral grant upon his hire as an Assistant Professor.

X. TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

Master's Students

Abdul-Matin Adam. 2025. "Assessing the impact of Hospital Closures on the Quality of Life of Rural residents and their effect on long term economic growth." Placement: Washington State University, School of Economic Sciences, Agricultural Economics, Ph.D. Student

Kelsey Lensegrav. 2023. "Estimating the Effect of Climate Change on Snowmobiling in Wyoming." Placement: Tegeler & Associates, Commercial Lines Account Manager.

Postdoctoral Research Associates

Dr. Anja Gruber. 2025-present

XI. PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Rural Economic Development Institute (REDI) at Colorado State University
North American Community Development Extension Professionals (NACDEP)
Federal Statistical Research Data Centers (FSRDC) – U.S. Census Bureau
North American Regional Science International (NARSC, SRSA)
American Agricultural Economics Association (AAEA)
Western Agricultural Economics Association (WAEA)

XII. SERVICE AND RECOGNITION

Service

USDA-NIFA Federal Grant Peer Review Panelist – 2024
Editorial Board Member of *Reaching Regions*, an outreach journal for NARSC – 2024
President of the Wyoming Association of Community Development Extension Professionals (WACDEP) – 2023-2024
Outgoing-Chair of Community and Regional Economics Network (CRENET) – 2023-2024
President of Hatch Multi-state project NE2249: “Sustainable and Inclusive Rural Economic Development to Enhance Housing, Health, Entrepreneurship, and Equity” – 2023
AAEA Conference Presentation Reviewer: Rural/Community Development – 2024
AAEA Topic Leader for Rural Development Sessions – 2021-2022, 2022-2023
President-Elect of Hatch Multi-state project NE2249: “Sustainable and Inclusive Rural Economic Development to Enhance Housing, Health, Entrepreneurship, and Equity” – 2023
Chair of Community and Regional Economics Network (CRENET) – 2022-2023
WAEA Topic Leader for Community and Regional Economics – 2022
USDA-NIFA Federal Grant Peer Review Panelist – 2022
Chair of Community Development Education (UW Ext.) – 2021-2022
Reviewer for Dan Rickman Best Paper Award (*Review of Regional Science*) – 2021
AAEA Conference Presentation Reviewer: Rural/Community Development – 2019
WAEA Conference Presentation Reviewer – 2019
President of CSU Agricultural and Resource Economics Graduate Council – 2017-2018

Journal Article Referee:

- American Journal of Agricultural Economics
- Review of Regional Studies
- Growth and Change
- Cities
- Journal of Rural and Community Development
- Letters in Spatial and Resource Economics
- International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health
- Journal of Food Distribution Research
- Renewable Agriculture and Food Systems
- Agriculture and Human Values
- Atlantic Economic Journal

- Agricultural and Resource Economics Review

Recognition

Top Cited Article in *Journal of Regional Science*, 2022-2023
AAEA Health Economics Section Best Paper award – July, 2022
Dan Rickman Best Paper Award (*Review of Regional Science*) – March, 2020
College of Agriculture Graduate Student Teaching Award – April, 2018
NARSC Student-led Paper Competition, 2nd place – November, 2016
CSU Jack Smith Memorial Scholarship in Agribusiness – October, 2016
AAEA Graduate Student Extension Competition, 2nd place – August, 2016
Food Distribution Research Society Case Study Competition, 3rd place – October, 2015
AAEA Graduate Student Case Study Competition, 3rd place – August, 2014
Cum Laude, Linfield College – May, 2012
Mathematical Competition in Modeling, “Meritorious” (top 10% worldwide) – 2012

2025 Extension Reporting

Anders Van Sandt, Ph.D.

Assistant Professor

40% Extension, 30% Teaching, 20% Research, 10% Service

Activity/Contact Reporting

- September 5th: Met with University of Wyoming public health specialists to consult on the forthcoming national Rural Transformation Grants.
- September 9th: Participated in the REDI Leadership Discussion
- September 10th: Participated in the CED PRU Quarterly Meeting
- September 26th: Presented research on Extension activities tied to a recently closed grant at a CFARE Webinar
- September 26th: Presented research on rural communities' resilience toward natural disasters at the Water in the West Colloquium at University of Wyoming
- October 2nd: Participated in a stakeholder meeting held by Colorado Department of Health Care Policy and Financing for upcoming Rural Health Transformation Program.
- October 2nd: Met with Jen Aengst regarding future potential collaborations in health Extension programming.
- October 7th-9th: Participated in Fall Forum for Extension
- November 5th: Met with Sue Schneider (lead of Health and Wellbeing PRU) regarding how best to integrate into existing efforts, where to augment, and where to create
- November 7th: Present poster on agritourism and outdoor recreation and its economic, cultural, and environmental linkages to Colorado communities at *Snow Days*.
- November 17th: Participated in REDI leadership meeting regarding new funding strategies for Extension and research activities given the retrenchment of University Centers.
- November 18th: Provided expert interview with The Denver Gazette regarding the rising cost of living in Colorado.
- December 2nd: Participated in an informative meeting held by Colorado Department of Health Care Policy and Financing regarding their final Rural Health Transformation Program grant proposal.
- December 2nd: Met with Will Slate, the Economic Development Manager for the City of Englewood, regarding their long term goals and recent efforts. This was a relationship building meeting to identify future partnerships.
- December 3rd: Participated in the CED PRU quarterly meeting
- December 9th: Met with Audrey Snyder Welsh, the new Executive Director of the Central Mountain SBDC, to discuss her county's goals and needs.
- December 11th: Provided expert interview with The Denver Gazette regarding the economic impacts of lower gas prices on the Front Range and around Colorado.
- December 16th: Met with Jen Aengst to flesh out grant proposal idea on a data tool to assist women find health resources.

Presentations

Van Sandt, A., Carpenter, C. W. (2025). Mapping Economic Opportunity in Rural America. Council on Food, Agricultural, and Resource Economics (C-FARE) Webinar: Timely Topics in Regional

Economic Development. September 26th, 2025.

<https://www.cfare.org/items/regionaleconomicdevelopment>

Keller, M., **Van Sandt, A.** (2025). Unwinding the Spiral of Silence in Rural America: Looking Backward with Stories to Plan Forward. Water in the West Colloquium. University of Wyoming. September 26th, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming's Local Food System. Wyoming Food Coalition's Speaker Series. Online. June 26th, 2025.

Publications

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Food Assistance and Resilience in Colorado: The Changing Role of SNAP. REDI Report. Regional Economic Development Institute, Colorado State University. November 12, 2025.

Van Sandt, A. (2025). Growing Resilience and Independence Through Wyoming's Local Food System. University of Wyoming Extension. Bulletin publication number B-1402. February 10, 2025.

Media Appearances & Interviews

Braithwaite, M. (2025). "Gas Price Drop Could Increase Holiday Spending, Experts Say". Expert interview with The Denver Gazette. December 12, 2025

Braithwaite, M. (2025). "Can You Afford to Live in Denver?". Expert interview with The Denver Gazette. December 4, 2025.

Grants

Farm and Food Rural Analytics for Market Empowerment: Food and Agriculture Mapper and Explorer (FAME) Updates and Analysis. **\$126,635 funded cooperative agreement** from USDA-AMS. Co-PI with Libby Christensen, Dawn Thilmany, Matt McFadden, and Jayna Mallon. October 2025.